



Total Bandwidth Server

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Outline

- Background: EDF and the utilization bound
- The Total Bandwidth Server: core idea and deadline rule
- Comparison with other aperiodic servers
- UPPAAL model and application example
- Experimental results and formal verification
- Discussion and conclusion

Background: EDF and the Utilization Bound

- EDF (Earliest Deadline First): dynamic priority, always run nearest deadline
- Optimal on a uniprocessor: if any algorithm can schedule the set, EDF can
- Schedulable under EDF if $U_p = \sum C_i / T_i \leq 1$
- RM (Rate Monotonic): fixed priority $\propto 1/\text{period}$; bound only $\ln 2 \approx 69.3\%$
- EDF reaches full 100% utilization — more efficient than RM

$$U_p = \sum (C_i / T_i) \leq 1 \rightarrow \text{EDF schedulability bound}$$

The Total Bandwidth Server — Core Idea

- Proposed by Spuri & Buttazzo (1996), within the EDF framework
- Reserve a fraction U_s of the processor for aperiodic tasks
- A virtual server — no time slots, no replenishment queue
- On each aperiodic arrival, assign a synthetic absolute deadline
 - The deadline places the job in the EDF queue alongside periodic tasks
 - Long-run aperiodic CPU consumption is bounded by U_s
- Bandwidth-optimal and extremely lightweight at runtime

TBS Deadline-Assignment Rule

$$d_k = \max(r_k , d_{k-1}) + C_k / U_s \quad (d_0 = 0)$$

- d_k : synthetic deadline assigned to the k-th aperiodic job
- r_k : arrival (release) time of the k-th job
- d_{k-1} : deadline assigned to the previous aperiodic job
- C_k : worst-case execution time of the k-th job
- U_s : server utilization (bandwidth reservation), $0 < U_s < 1$
- max keeps deadlines non-decreasing $\rightarrow$ aperiodic use $\leq U_s \cdot \Delta t$ in any interval

Comparison with Other Aperiodic Servers

Server	Characteristic vs. TBS
Polling Server	Wastes bandwidth if no aperiodic pending
Deferrable Server	Preserves capacity, but extra schedulability cost
Sporadic Server	Needs replenishment bookkeeping; more complex
CBS	Handles overruns / unknown WCET; heavier mechanism
TBS	$O(1)$, no waste — spare capacity flows to periodics

UPPAAL Model Architecture

PeriodicGenerator

Releases periodic
jobs each period

AperiodicGenerator

Assigns TBS
synthetic deadline

Scheduler (CPU)

EDF select, 1-unit
step, miss check

- Network of timed automata; one generator process per task (parameterized)
- Discrete time: integer currentTime; cpuClock measures one unit per cycle
- Committed chain MissCheck → Release → Select → Dispatch → Run / Idle
- Integer arithmetic reproduces the exact preemptive EDF schedule

Application Example

- Periodic tasks: $\tau_0 = (1, 4)$, $U_0 = 1/4$ and $\tau_1 = (2, 6)$, $U_1 = 1/3$
- Periodic load: $U_p = 1/4 + 1/3 = 7/12 \approx 0.58$
- Server bandwidth: $U_s = 1/4 \rightarrow C_k / U_s = 4 \cdot C_k$
- Combined: $U_p + U_s = 7/12 + 3/12 = 5/6 \approx 0.83 \leq 1 \quad \checkmark$
- Three aperiodic jobs: J_0 at $t=2$ ($C=1$), J_1 at $t=8$ ($C=1$), J_2 at $t=14$ ($C=2$)
- Observation window: HORIZON = 24 time units

Worked Synthetic Deadlines

Job	r_k	C_k	C_k/U_s	d_k
J_0	2	1	4	6
J_1	8	1	4	12
J_2	14	2	8	22

- $d_k = \max(r_k, d_{k-1}) + C_k/U_s$ applied with $U_s = 1/4$
- Deadlines serialized non-decreasing: $6 \rightarrow 12 \rightarrow 22$, placed in the EDF queue
- Integrated EDF schedule over $[0, 24)$: every deadline met, CPU idle 6 of 24 units

Experimental Results

Job	Arrival	Finish	Resp.	d_k	Met?
J_0	2	3	1	6	yes
J_1	8	9	1	12	yes
J_2	14	18	4	22	yes

- All response times far below synthetic deadlines; deadlineMiss stays false
- Utilization over window: periodic 14/24, aperiodic 4/24 ($< U_s=0.25$), idle 6/24
- Unused server capacity flows to the periodic set rather than being wasted
- All 7 TCTL verification queries hold (deadlock-free, no miss, deadlines = 6/12/22)

Continuous model — verified over unbounded time, all sporadic arrival patterns:

- $A[]$ not deadlock — scheduler runs forever
- $A[]$ not deadlineMiss — NO deadline ever missed, over all time, for every arrival pattern (now a genuine proof, not one-window evidence)
- $A[]$ not aperiodicOverflow — bounded job pool never overflows
- $A[]$ serverSlack $\leq C_k/U_s$ — TBS throttles aperiodic work to at most U_s
- aperiodicActive[0] $\rightarrow$ not aperiodicActive[0] — liveness: every request eventually served, never starved

Advantages

- $O(1)$ overhead — fits constrained embedded systems
- Inherits EDF optimality
- No bandwidth wasted vs. Polling / Deferrable servers
- Spare capacity flows to periodic tasks

Limitations

- WCET C_k must be known at arrival time
- Handles only soft aperiodic tasks (synthetic deadlines)
- Distributed end-to-end deadlines need extra mechanisms
- Continuous UPPAAL model now proves no deadline miss over unbounded time for all sporadic arrivals; bounded run remains illustrative

Conclusion

- TBS elegantly integrates aperiodic tasks into EDF-scheduled systems
- Deadline rule $d_k = \max(r_k, d_{k-1}) + C_k/U_s$ bounds bandwidth with $O(1)$ overhead
- Simple schedulability condition: $U_p + U_s \leq 1$
- UPPAAL model (3 templates, discrete-time EDF) verified deadlock-free and miss-free
- Assigned deadlines match theory (6, 12, 22); aperiodic share within reserved U_s
- Future work: distributed precedence constraints; compare against CBS

References

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